The Rite of the Sequence of Activities of the Hevajra Maṇḍala

Hevajramaṇḍalakarmakramavidhi · Toh 1263 · Derge Tengyur
ཀྱེ་དོ་རྗེ་འཁྱིལ་འཁོར་གྱི་ལས་ཀྱི་རིམ་པའི་ཆོ་ག

The Rite of the Sequence of Activities of the Hevajra Maṇḍala, in Sanskrit Hevajramaṇḍalakarmakramavidhi and in Tibetan Kyé dorjé kyilkhor gyi lé kyi rimpé choga, is a tantric ritual manual for the conferral of empowerment in the Hevajra cycle. It guides a qualified master step by step, from examining the qualities of a suitable student and preparing and drawing the maṇḍala, through the series of empowerments with their mantras, verses and visualizations, to the offering of the master's fee, the closing feast gathering, and the dismantling of the maṇḍala. Its colophon attributes it to the master Saroruhavajra and records that it was translated into Tibetan by the Indian preceptor Gayādhara and the monk Shakya Yeshé. It is Toh 1263 in the Tengyur, where it belongs to the section of tantra commentaries, among the works of the Hevajra cycle.

In the language of India: he vajra maṇḍal karma krama bidhiḥ. In the language of Tibet: The Rite of the Sequence of Activities of the Hevajra Maṇḍala.

Homage to glorious Hevajra.

First, the master who has received empowerment from his guru, who abides by the pledges and possesses all the qualifications, draws the maṇḍala in order to confer empowerment on a student. First he should examine the qualities of the student. He should take into his care a student who is gentle and speaks pleasantly, who has love and compassion for all sentient beings, who is devoted to study, reflection and reading, who, through the profound way of skillful means and wisdom, has great faith in the secret Dharma, who is respectful toward the guru, who is fearless regarding the treatises, and who possesses great generosity.

After examining the student in this way, one should first perform the approach practice of the deity. Here the mantra recitation of the principal deity should be done a hundred thousand times, and the recitation of the goddesses a thousand times. On this point some masters hold that the recitation of the eight goddesses is not needed. Why? Because they are limbs of the hero, they say that doing the hero alone is sufficient.

When signs arise from doing the recitation in this way, one should begin to draw the maṇḍala. First, making the pure mind manifest and endowed with Hevajra, one pleases the deities, and in order to draw the maṇḍala one should thoroughly examine the ground: an extremely secluded forest, the dwelling of a bodhisattva, the shore of a great ocean, a charnel ground, a place of accomplishment, a place where a maṇḍala was made before, or else a pleasing spot to which one's own mind is drawn, beautiful and delightful. One sprinkles it with fragrant water and strews various flowers. Whatever the place may be, if it slopes to the east and the north, the yogins will attain accomplishment. If the center is high, one will attain the state of a vidyādhara of the great seal. If the north is high, one will be followed by the ḍākinīs. If the east is high, one will come to the full realization of the four families, the five and so forth. If the center of the ground is low, the mantra practitioner will be beset by fears. Having practiced in a place that has the right characteristics in this way, one will gain whatever accomplishment one desires. This is the stage of examining the ground.

In the center of the ground examined in this way, one sits endowed with Hevajra and urges and supplicates the earth goddess Pṛthivī: one should strike the ground three times with the fingers of both hands. One imagines that, at the striking, she emerges from within the earth and comes to stay before the yogin. One imagines that goddess adorned with all ornaments, yellow in color, lovely of face and beautiful, holding a vase in her hand, and saying, "What shall I do? Please command me." To the goddess so imagined one offers water for welcome, water for the feet, offerings and torma, and one should speak thus:

Of all the buddhas, the protectors,
their way of conduct and its distinctions,
the grounds and the perfections,
you, goddess, have been the witness.
Just as Śākyasiṃha, the protector,
vanquished the hosts of Māra,
so I, victorious over the hosts of Māra,
shall draw the maṇḍala.

Having said this three times, one imagines that the earth goddess, radiant with joy, says, "You are the master: make the maṇḍala!" and dissolves into the ground. This is the stage of requesting the ground.

Then one sprinkles the area with fragrant water and sprinkles it with the five nectars. Then, having ascertained the position of the mahoraga, one should dig down to the depth of the throat, the navel or the knees, for supreme, middling or lesser accomplishment. Then the ground, cleared of the earth's refuse, such as stones, charred wood, charcoal, bones, potsherds, gravel and clods, is filled with good, rich earth mixed with fine fragrances such as sandalwood, saffron, camphor and musk. Or else one mixes fragrances and water, mixes it with water over which the syllable hūṃ has been recited, pounds it firm and fills the pit, and inserts earth treasures of precious substances and the like. Upon the surface, made level like the palm of the hand, the yogin endowed with the six limbs sits, and by saying oṃ rakṣa rakṣa he makes the whole ground into the nature of vajra. Below and above he makes a vajra tent and a vajra canopy. Then with oṃ vajrī bhava vajra bandha hūṃ he makes everything luminous.

O goddess, you will be the witness
to the worship of wrathful Hevajra.
With powder ground from various jewels
I shall draw the meaningful maṇḍala.

don debi śākya buddhasi hevajra krodhanana ratnanadaritato ātmako'haṃ maṇḍalna khedaṃ. This is the stage of blessing the ground and abiding in the preparation.

Then the guru, endowed with the six limbs and wearing the five ornaments, namely the crossed ornament on the crown, the necklace, the earrings, the belt and the bracelets, and holding vajra and bell, sits in front of what was described above. Those in the samādhis of the four families, the goddess Gaurī and the others, sit in the four directions, holding vajra and bell, and should perform the exhortation. Before the exhortation one makes offerings: the one in the samādhi of Gaurī makes offering with the five kinds of offering, oṃ vajra puṣpe āḥ hūṃ, oṃ vajra dhūpe āḥ hūṃ, oṃ vajra dīpe āḥ hūṃ, oṃ vajra gandhe āḥ hūṃ, oṃ vajra naivetye āḥ hūṃ, and praises with the verse beginning "You are surrounded by the yoginīs." Then one exhorts in these words:

"Peace of all the tathāgatas,
Abode of all the tathāgatas,
Source of all, O guide, please teach
The maṇḍala of Vajrasattva.

Perfectly complete in every mark,
Perfectly free of all that is no mark,
Samantabhadra, great in all,
O guide, please teach his maṇḍala.

Perfect buddha, supreme peace,
Who fully practices the conduct of wisdom,
Vajra speech, the source of all,
O guide, please teach the maṇḍala.

Great mind of every sentient being,
Pure by nature, free of stain,
Source of the great Vairocana,
O guide, please teach the maṇḍala."

Then the one who meditates as Hevajra, endowed with the five mudrās mentioned above, should dispel the obstructors. One imagines a crossed vajra arising from hūṃ on each foot, a sun disc arising from ma in the right eye, and a moon disc arising from ṭa in the left, and one looks in every direction with the vajra gaze, gazing as it is said:

"Moreover, very swiftly
Drawing the eyelashes:
This is called the blazing gaze;
It summons all beings."

Holding the bell in the left hand and brandishing the vajra in the right, crossing the arms well, one above the other, one should drive out those who dwell at that site with these words: "Since I am about to undertake the welfare of sentient beings at this site, all you gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, bhūtas, piśācīs, rākṣasīs and the rest who are lords of this place, go quickly! Having heard the command of glorious Heruka, depart at once! Whoever does not go, his head will be split into a hundred pieces by my wisdom vajra and by this khaṭvāṅga." One says this three times, and, beginning from the quarter of Īśāna, the northeast, reciting many hūṃ syllables, one circles three times clockwise. One imagines that light rays like the fire at the end of the eon issue from beneath one's feet, so that the malevolent ones are burned and scatter in every direction.

This is to be danced with the eight playful steps:

Moving the feet and moving the hands,
Raising the brows, opened wide in great delight,
Slightly bashful, with sidelong glances,
A fierce gaze like the full moon,
Wide eyes, while performing the dance,
The lotus of the mouth with a smile,
Bearing fangs that are slightly red,
A garland white like kunda flowers,
Glorious Heruka, supreme yogin,
Wondrous liberator of sentient beings:
With dances such as these
One should drive away the obstructors and the rest.

Then, with the rakṣa mantra given earlier, one makes the vajra ground, the vajra tent, the vajra canopy and the rest. When this is done, even a site for the maṇḍala that has faults becomes free of faults. This is the stage of dispelling the obstructors.

Then one smears the ground with fragrant water containing the five products of the cow, and with the water of the five nectars. On that one makes a dot of scent, and on the dot one places a flower, imagining it to be a crossed lotus. On the lotus one imagines a sun disc arising from oṃ. On that, from their own mantras, hūṃ gaṃ caṃ vaṃ ghaṃ paṃ saṃ laṃ ḍaṃ, one generates the wheel of the yoga deities, and imagines each one seated on its own seat.

Then one should invite the wisdom being together with the retinue. Exhorting with gaurī jaḥ, many hook-holding Gaurīs emanated from Gaurī stream forth and invite Hevajra together with his retinue from the natural maṇḍala. As they abide above the vajra canopy, the yogins make offering to them with drokṣaṇ, argha, añca, vidhi, incense, flowers and the rest, and they also make offering with the offerings of the eight goddesses. Then, with caurī hūṃ, Caurī holding the noose leads them into the celestial palace. With vetālī vaṃ, Vetālī likewise binds them. With ghasmarī hoḥ, Ghasmarī delights them, and one makes them into a single wheel of wisdom.

Then one makes offering with the outer offerings, and also with the inner offerings. With the sound of the bell one praises with the words of vajra song, such as:

"Because existence is pure by nature,
Through its essential nature it is made a non-entity.

May the beings who are pure by nature
Bring about the sublime existence."

and:

"Supreme nature of all things,
From the beginning all abide in their own nature;
Method and wisdom, not two:
Hevajra, I pay homage to you."

Then the nectar offering is also made to glorious Hevajra and his retinue. Then one should say this:

"Arisen from nondual wisdom,
All-pervading lord, embodiment of accomplishment,
Chief of teachers, glorious Heruka,
Perfectly united with Nairātmyā,
Ḍākinīs of the directions and intermediate directions,
Goddesses of knowledge with miraculous power,
Bodhisattvas and all the others,
Every one of you, please heed me.
To benefit the disciple
And to make offering to you,
I, the vajra holder, as I know it,
Shall draw the maṇḍala tomorrow.
Attending to me with loving kindness,
Please bestow your blessing."

Then one should offer garlands of fragrant flowers, the five nectars, incense and so on. This is the stage of supplicating the deities.

Then the chief disciple together with the others is to be consecrated, and, to make offering, one recites this:

"Come here, my child! For the Great Vehicle
You are a vessel of the great way.
This rite, the way of conduct of secret mantra,
I shall rightly explain to you.

The perfect buddhas who have passed,
Likewise those who have not yet come,
And the perfect buddhas who have now arisen

And abide for the benefit of beings:
Having known this excellent rite
Of the secret mantra of them all,
The hero, at the foot of the tree of awakening,
Attained immeasurable omniscience.
The practice of secret mantra is unequaled:
By the protector, glorious Heruka,
The hosts of Māra, utterly unbearable,
Great armies though they were, were vanquished.
Therefore, in order to attain omniscience,
Child, make this resolve."

"In the Buddha, the Dharma and the Saṅgha
I always take refuge.
In the yoga, the secret mantra, the ḍākinīs,
Those whose very nature is to abide in the wheel,
In all of them I always take refuge.
In the heroes, the heroines, the goddesses of empowerment,
The bodhisattvas, the great beings,
And above all in the master,
I always take refuge.
Glorious Heruka and the others,
The yoginīs, Vairocana and the others,
The selfless bodhisattvas,
All of you, please heed me.
I, so-and-so, from this time onward,
For as long as I abide in selflessness,
Shall rightly hold my vow,
Its nondual pure conduct."

Then one has them also perform the confession of wrongdoing and the rest with the following:

"Whatever wrongdoing I have done,
Caused to be done, or rejoiced in,
Having come before the buddhas,
All of it I confess.
The buddhas, the bodhisattvas,
The pratyekabuddhas, the arhats and other beings:

In the collections of merit
Of their meditation and recitation I rejoice.
The generation of the mind, the full awakening,
The turning of the wheel of Dharma,
And the conduct of the hosts of bodhisattvas:
In these I take refuge.
Just as the buddhas arise,
And just as the fortunate bodhisattvas
Generated the supreme mind of awakening,
So here and now I generate that mind.
Protectors, please heed me.
Buddhas who abide, all without exception,
From this very time until I awaken,
Unsurpassed ones, please look upon me.

The Buddha, the Dharma and the Saṅgha,
The unsurpassed Three Jewels,
The vow of the buddha yoga,
I shall rightly take up.
Of the great supreme vajra family,
The vajra, the bell and the mudrā
I shall also rightly take up,
And the master as well I shall take up.
For the pleasing pledge
Of the great supreme jewel family,
Every day, or at the six times,
I shall always give the four kinds of giving.
Of the pure supreme lotus family,
Arisen from great awakening,
The sublime Dharma of the three vehicles,
Outer, inner and secret, I shall take up entirely.
Of the great supreme karma family,
Possessing all its vows,
I shall rightly take them up,
And I shall perform acts of offering as far as I can.
The discipline of the training,
The gathering of virtuous qualities,

And the discipline of working for beings, these three,
I shall likewise always take up.
Through these virtuous actions of mine,
Swiftly attaining buddhahood for the world before long,
May I bring the beings sunk in the ocean of saṃsāra
To unsurpassed awakening itself."

When they have made this request, the master should protect the disciples. On the body, speech and mind of all the disciples, there is a wheel at the crown of the head, a lotus at the throat and a vajra at the heart, and at the centers of these three, oṃ āḥ hūṃ, oṃ āḥ hūṃ. Then the master, holding a vajra in his hand, touches the vajra to the three places of the disciple while reciting oṃ āḥ hūṃ, and anoints them with scented water. Then in turn he gives a flower on the head of each disciple, gives incense in front of them, and gives a lamp and scent at the heart.

Then the rite of the tooth stick is to be performed:

A pleasing stick of udumbara or aśvattha,
Bound with flowers and smeared with scent,
Is to be made twelve finger-widths long,
Not bent, not split, not eaten by insects.
With cow dung, on ground the size of a cowhide,
Having made a maṇḍala,
One sets the disciple upon it
And makes offering with flowers and the rest.
It is to be given to the assembly of disciples.
Then, facing east,
In silence they chew the tooth stick.
Once it has been chewed, it is not to be set down,
Nor is it thrown this way and that:
The tooth stick is thrown straight ahead.
The signs at that time are these:
If it then points toward oneself
And its tip stands upright,
That is declared to be the supreme accomplishment.
Likewise if it points elsewhere,
That is declared to be the middling accomplishment.
If it points to an intermediate direction or to the north,

One gains a worldly accomplishment.
If, once in a hundred throws of the tooth stick,
It points downward,
Then certainly the accomplishment of the underworld
Will come; of that there is no doubt.

Then, having washed well with scented water, they are to sprinkle and drink. oṃ viśuddha dharma pāpaṃ nicāsya śodhaya sarva vikalpan apanāya hūṃ: this is the mantra with which one has them drink three sips of the water over which it has been recited.

After that, in order to gladden the minds of the disciples, the Dharma is to be taught:

"In all the realms of the world
An omniscient one does not appear;
Like the udumbara flower,
Only once in a hundred times does one arise.
Therefore, through this profound way of conduct,
The nondual, so rarely met,
Which brings beings to buddhahood,
Whatever ripening there is of deeds
Done before in many countless eons,
All of it is exhausted
By seeing the profound maṇḍala."

Then one blesses kuśa grass with oṃ āḥ hūṃ and places it as a pillow, and spreads it also as a mat. Then the protection cord is tied: one ties six knots in a red protection cord and fastens it on the left upper arm; it is bound for protection.

Then, having made offerings and given the torma, the master goes inside and makes full offering to the deities of the maṇḍala with outer and inner offerings. The disciples, at that very place of preparation, lie down on the kuśa mat in the lion posture. In order to observe the signs in their dreams, they should keep Hevajra in mind in silence and sleep with a mind of meditative concentration. At the end of that night one should ask them what dreams they have had. Having heard what they say, one should declare without hesitation whether the dreams are good or bad. Then, if good dreams were seen, one should rejoice with the disciple and declare the supreme, middling or lesser

accomplishment. If bad ones were seen, one has them drink the five products of the cow and performs a fierce fire offering. By that the troubling thoughts will be pacified.

This is the stage of placing the disciples in the preparatory consecration.

Then one makes the victory vase of gold, silver or copper; if these are not available, it is to be made of clay. For the other vases too, if the full number of jewel vases cannot be found, they are to be made of clay. All are smeared with white earth, and they are set down on lotuses at whose centers the hand emblems have been arranged.

Then one imagines the vases to be without intrinsic nature, and from that they become a white letter khaṃ. From the white khaṃ melting into light there arises a vase, white and free of black streaks, which one visualizes with a long neck, a large belly and a hanging lip. Inside it, from a red paṃ, there comes a lotus; upon it, from a, a sun disc; and upon that hūṃ gaṃ caṃ vaṃ ghaṃ paṃ śaṃ laṃ ḍaṃ. From their complete transformation one generates the wheel of deities in its entirety. Then one invites the wisdom wheel, and with the four mudrās beginning with gaurī jaḥ one summons them, draws them in, binds them and delights them, and imagines them as inseparable. One then makes to them the prokṣaṇa, the argha, the añcamānaṃ and the vidhi, the five kinds of offering, and the praises to the eight goddesses. Then one recites the mantra one hundred and eight times and sets the vase down. Then one also makes offering with incense, and scatters white flowers in profusion, and so on.

Then one imagines that the deities melt into light and that the vase is filled with brilliant white bodhicitta. Then one pours in good scented water to fill it, and also adds medicinal substances and the like, made from the roots of śveta bṛhati, aparajita, danda, utpala, kaṇḍakari, hasadeva and other plants; here these serve as signs of the bodhicitta of the maṇḍala. Rice, māṣa beans, barley, sesame and wheat: these are the nature of the minds of the deities of the maṇḍala. Crystal, silver, pearl, conch and coral serve as signs of the body colors of the maṇḍala. In addition, one puts in moon, sun, water, medicine, scent, molasses, sugar and foods.

The vase is to be furnished with the five, beginning with the emblem of its lord, and its neck is to be bound with cloths of blue, white, yellow, red and green. If these are not available, one binds a single length of cloth around the top. Its mouth is to be adorned with a fine kind of leafy tree branch, complete

with fruit, leaves and twigs. Into the other vases medicinal substances and the like are not put; for them it is done from each deity melting into light. The offering, the praise and the mantra recitation are the same for all.

Then one spreads a cloth, scatters white flowers in profusion upon it, and requests the vases to be seated on it. At that time one also presents the offerings of dance. The vase of all activities is marked with a crossed vajra; one makes offering to it and requests it to be seated at the outer northeast corner. One entrusts it with the words, "Please protect against all obstructors until the activity is accomplished." Nine tormas, nine lamps, nine food offerings for the deities, and nine incense offerings: this is the rite of preparation for consecrating the vases.

On the day after the preparation, an increasing fire offering is to be performed during the day.

The master, possessed of good qualifications, knowing the reality of true wisdom, free of anger, free of resentment, wise and endowed with the mudrā, requests the deities of the maṇḍala to come into the sky before him. Then one should begin the work of laying down the lines.

For this, cotton is spun by a wisdom woman who has the proper marks, without knots, tangles and the like, to a length twice that of the maṇḍala and a thickness one twentieth of a door. Having spun it, one binds the threads together separately and places them inside a padma bhanddha vessel smeared with fragrance, and one meditates that the threads are without intrinsic nature. From that they become their respective syllables, and from the complete transformation of the syllables one imagines that the threads arise. Then, from the heart of the wisdom being, with the hook of the yogin's eyes, which bear the sun and the moon, one draws forth the wisdom threads:

The chief, Hevajra, and
The ḍākinīs of all the buddhas,
The chief, the mantra, and the nondual ones:
Having invited them, one dissolves them into it.

Having thus generated the wisdom line cords, one twists the five threads into one while reciting the mantra of the chief. One should recite oṃ vajra samaya sūtraṃ mātikrama hūṃ one hundred and eight times. One sets the three, oṃ āḥ hūṃ, at the two ends and in the middle, blesses it, and presents offerings to it. Then from the heart of the chief one emanates a companion to hold the thread, has him say ja ja, and hands it over. First one should lay the lines in

the sky. Exhorting, one says:

"When the line cords are laid down,
For all the realms of the world without exception,
The buddhas and the others, for the sake of beings,
I am able to accomplish your purpose."

Likewise the actual lines are also to be laid down. The master sits at the quarter of Varuṇa, the west, and the disciple sits at the quarter of Śakra (Indra), the east, and they lay down the Brahmā line. The master sits in the direction of Yama, the south, and the disciple sits at the quarter of the yakṣas, the north, and they lay down the second Brahmā line. The master sits at the quarter of Agni, the southeast, and the disciple at Īśāna, the northeast, and they lay down the east line. The master sits in the direction of Vāyu, the northwest, and the disciple at Nairṛti, the southwest, and they lay down the west line. The master stays in that same place, and the disciple sits at Īśāna, and they lay down the north line. The master sits at Agni, and the disciple at Nairṛti, and they should lay down the south line.

Since it is said,

"The lines are all to be laid with thread,
But one should not measure with thread,
For it has the faults of stretching and shrinking;
One should measure precisely with something rigid,"

one makes a measuring rod of something straight and rigid, such as bamboo, and lays forty-two line units on each side. Having laid the forty-two lines in this way, one draws a circle around the center of the lotus with the line reaching as far as the door enclosure. The circle of the lotus anthers is drawn from the band of the deities, as large as is fitting. At the edge of the maṇḍala one draws one part each for the vajra fence and the fire light. From the sides of the four bands of the porticoes, half a part. Of the four large sections of the sides, on one there is a wheel of Dharma, and on one the central line of the crossed vajra, its tip to be directed toward the stem of the lotus.

Then the guru sits in the center of the maṇḍala, imagines sun and moon discs in his two eyes, gazes with eyes turned back, and with hi hi imagines that he opens the doors. Then he says vajra vela and comes out. Then, when the work of laying down the lines is finished, one makes offerings to the wisdom cord, says sarva ma ra ta rci pa ra artha rca sa ti ta ta gaccha, and requests the deities to depart. This is the stage of laying down the wisdom lines.

Then one sets out rice, well dyed in colors, in the order of the colors. One makes it without intrinsic nature and imagines it transformed into the five, bhrūṃ aṃ jrāṃ khaṃ hūṃ. From their complete transformation one imagines that the five kinds of colored powder arise. Then, with the hook of the yogin's blazing eyes of sun and moon, one invites Hevajra and the ḍākinīs together with their retinue, and imagines that they dissolve into the colors. One recites oṃ vajra citrā samaya hūṃ many times and presents offerings to the colored sands. Starting from the northeast corner, following the order of the gurus, one draws the five lines, black, white, yellow, red and green, evenly for the length of one span, and presents offerings, scattering loose flowers on the lines. Then, at the moment of drawing the lines, the guru says this:

"This is the pure dharmadhātu,
Which liberates the realm of sentient beings,
Glorious Heruka, the king himself,
The abode of all the tathāgatas."

For it is said:

"Being completely free of all faults,
One properly begins the work with the colors.
The master is the first to lay them out,
And afterward the disciples throughout.
With the little finger and the thumb,
One should draw properly, straight and raised.
If the lines are uneven,
Crooked or low,
Through a low line there is no success,
A crooked one gives rise to suffering,
And through a broken one, it should be known,
Both master and disciple will die."

Therefore one should be extremely careful. Then the maṇḍala is to be drawn properly in accordance with the scripture. This is the stage of laying out the colors.

When the maṇḍala has been drawn in this way, the emblems are now to be placed. At the central hub one draws the four Māras crossed, and upon a sun disc a white narakapāla, a skull cup, together with a crossed vajra. In the east one draws a black curved knife; in the south a pale red ḍamaru; in the west a reddish-yellow tortoise; in the north a green snake; in the northeast a

reddish-blue lion; in the southeast a white monk; in the southwest a bluish-green wheel; and in the northwest a multicolored vajra: these are placed. As the emblems are being placed, one also places them while reciting the heart mantra of each deity. The eight vases too are to be drawn, or set, in their places in the east and the other directions. This is the stage of placing the emblems.

Then one hangs a fine canopy, and draws and arranges all the other ornaments as well. Outside, one sets up the tormas of the guardians of the directions; one generates the guardians of the directions from their seed syllables, invites the wisdom beings, dissolves them into them, and leaves them there. Then the vases are carried, led by incense and accompanied by various kinds of music; one circles the maṇḍala three times and places them properly. The vase of all activities is placed at the northeast corner.

Then, in the evening, the guru puts on ornaments and bathes, anoints his body with fragrance, and sprinkles water beside the maṇḍala. Then he sits on a comfortable seat and should practice together with a caṇḍālī; if there is none, it should be done through samādhi. Then the guru generates the wheel of deities endowed with the six limbs properly. Then, commanding Gaurī, he invites the deities and presents offerings to them. Then he draws them in, binds them and delights them, and dissolves them so that they are nondual. Offerings are then to be presented to them: one makes offering with the prokṣaṇa, the argha, the añcamānaṃ, the vidhi, incense, flowers and the rest, and with the offerings of the eight goddesses. One makes offering with cloth, with sandalwood and saffron falling like rain, and with all kinds of offerings. Then one also makes the nectar offering in due order. Then the deities are to be praised with the Twenty Praises. One also makes offering with various songs and with auspicious songs. One turns the great gaṇacakra, the feast gathering, recites a collection of aspirations, circumambulates three times, and also offers the nine tormas.

Here one proceeds to the conferral of empowerment. Following the stages for the entry of the disciple, the master himself should enter first. Then the disciple, previously examined and possessing the proper marks, should say this:

"In the master, the embodiment
Of the nature of all buddhas, I take refuge.
To the deities, the chief

Together with the goddesses, I pay homage.
Into the supreme city of great liberation,
Protector, please lead me in."

Thus one should supplicate the master. Then the master says this:

"Abode of all the tathāgatas,
Supreme city of glorious Heruka:
Into this maṇḍala of the heart essence
I shall lead the disciple."

Then one should pay homage to the deities of the maṇḍala by way of body, speech and mind: oṃ namaḥ te hūṃ, namaḥ mi hūṃ, namo nama hūṃ svāhā.

Then the rite of the vows is recited and the vows are conferred:

"The Buddha, the Dharma and the Saṅgha:
You have gone for refuge to the Three Jewels.
This is the pleasing buddha family;
The vow has become firm.
The vajra, the bell and the mudrā
You must take up, and the master too.
That which is bodhicitta is the vajra;
Wisdom is known as the bell.
You must take up the master,
The guru, who is equal to all the buddhas.
This is declared to be the pledge and vow
Of the pure vajra family.
For the jewel family, always,
Every day, at the six times,
Dharma, material things, fearlessness and love:
Always give these four kinds of giving.
The outer, inner and secret three vehicles,
The sublime Dharma, take up entirely.
This is the pleasing pledge
Of the pure lotus family.
Of the great supreme karma family,
Possessing all its vows,
I shall rightly take them up,
And I shall perform acts of offering as far as I can."

This is the taking up of the vows.

"Today you are entering among the heroes and the yoginīs. I shall generate in you the wisdom of glorious Heruka. If through it you will attain the accomplishments of all the tathāgatas and of all the heroes and yoginīs, what need is there even to mention other accomplishments? You must not speak of this in front of those who have not seen the maṇḍala, lest your pledge be broken.

Glorious Heruka has today
Truly entered your heart;
If you speak of this way,
At once he will tear it apart and depart."

Then the water of the pledge, with the five nectars, is poured into a skull cup, and one who is endowed with Hevajra, full of splendor, says this:

"This is your water of hell:
If you transgress the pledge, it burns you.
If you keep the pledge, accomplishment
Is gained through this water of vajra nectar.
oṃ sarva pañca amṛto ka ṭha hūṃ."

"From this time on, I am glorious Heruka himself, and whatever I command you, saying, 'Do this!', you must do. Do not do anything in contempt of me. If you do, you will die without being freed from misery and fall into hell."

Then one has the disciple say, "May all the heroes and yoginīs bless me! Glorious Heruka, please descend upon me!" One gives the disciple the five kinds of nectar to drink. The guru, with a majestic bearing, puts on the armor, and from the heart of the wisdom being at his own heart light rays stream forth, by which he summons the chief and the yoginīs and makes them enter the heart of the śiṣya, the disciple. Through their entering, the disciple becomes able to speak. Whichever of the colors of the four activities is seen, one teaches in accordance with it.

Then, holding a garland of flowers, the disciple says pratīccha vajra and casts it into the maṇḍala. Then it is to be bound on the disciple's head. Then, taking the disciple by the hand, one should open the eyes:

"Glorious Heruka today
Strives to open your eyes.
Once opened, they see all things:

The vajra eye is unsurpassed."

Saying oṃ vajra naitra apahara vatra laṃ hri, one removes the face covering and says this:

"Look upon this excellent maṇḍala.
Now generate intense faith.
You are born into the family of the yoginīs,
Blessed by mantra and by mudrā.
All the excellences of beings
And all accomplishments will become manifest.
Guard all the pledges,
And strive in secret mantra as well."

Having said this, one shows the disciple the deity on whom the flower fell, and shows the other deities as well: at the point of placing the body colors and the hand emblems, one makes the emblems recognizable by their colors and shows them, and one also shows the hand emblems properly. This is the stage of having the disciple enter the maṇḍala.

Accordingly, when the celestial palace appears as a square, it is the nature of the purified four immeasurables. The four doors are the nature of the purified four close applications of mindfulness. The four porticoes are the nature of the purified four right abandonments. The half-nets of hanging ornaments are the great afflictions purified. The nets are the minor afflictions purified. The eight pillars are the noble eightfold path purified. The ornaments, the silk hangings and the rest, are the characteristic of pure moral discipline. The five sense pleasures are form, sound and the rest purified. The vajra fence is the sign of turning the wheel of the profound Dharma. This mountain of fire is the sign of being unassailable by perverse obstructors and the like. The eight vases are the sign of flourishing with great qualities and being completely filled with the taste of great compassion. That is the reality of the maṇḍala.

The Blessed One Hevajra is the nature of the aggregate of consciousness and of aversion purified. Gaurī is the nature of aversion and form purified. Caurī is the nature of delusion and sound purified. Vetālī is the nature of pride and smell purified. Ghasmarī is the nature of attachment and taste purified. Pukkasī is the nature of aversion and earth purified. Śavarī is the nature of delusion and water purified. Caṇḍālī is the nature of pride and fire purified. Ḍombī is the nature of attachment and wind purified. The yoginī Nairātmyā

accords with the father. That is the reality of deity yoga.

Then the disciple bows with faith at the feet of the guru. Taking the finest gifts, he offers them to the guru and should make supplication in order to receive the empowerment:

"As glorious Heruka, full of splendor,
Conferred empowerment to protect beings
On the source of qualities and the others,
So today bestow it upon me.
Great hero, bestow upon me
The irreversible empowerment.
For the sake of all sentient beings,
I shall always act as a master."

Thus one should supplicate the master.

Then, on the south side of the entrance door of the maṇḍala, one sets up a lion throne upon a drawn eight-petaled lotus, spreads upon it a seat of a crossed lotus, and seats there the disciple, who has a nondual mind, is devoted to the guru, and is of great generosity. Having made offerings to the deities of the maṇḍala with effort, as much as one can, one holds a white parasol over the disciple and begins the empowerments of flower, water and the rest.

First, oneself full of splendor, one sprinkles white mustard seed and the water of the five nectars while reciting mantras, and drives away the obstructors that would interrupt the empowerment. One also makes the fence, the net, the tent and the rest. Then the disciple, having bathed and put on fine clothes, sits on the throne, fills his cupped hands with flowers and should cast them onto the maṇḍala. Saying the mantra oṃ pratīccha vajra ho, he casts them. Then one takes the flower that has fallen, binds it on the disciple's head, and says oṃ dharmā kundha abhiṣiñca. Then, with the two lotus hands, the mantra practitioner lifts the vases, touches them to the disciple's head, recites the mantra oṃ vajra aghiṣiñca mi tvaṃ, and confers the empowerment. Then, lifting the victory vase, ringing the bell and singing songs, one confers the water empowerment, reciting the mantra above. Through conferring the water empowerment in this way, one imagines that all the wrongdoing and obscurations of conceptual thought are no more.

It may be anything at all: hammered from gold or the like, carved in relief from ivory, drawn as a painting on a thangka or the like, or made of cloth of various kinds. One dissolves it into non-apprehension, and imagines Ratnasambhava

arising from aṃ. One summons the wisdom being into it, causes it to enter, binds it, and pleases it; then one dissolves it in and presents offerings. One also does as much recitation as one can. Then one should offer praise, and recite the words on the nature of existence. Having done this, the dissolving into the others, the offerings, the recitation, the praise, and the recitation of the words on the nature of existence should all be done in the same way for all of them. That has turned into the form of a crown; holding it with its two silk streamers, one should give it, saying this:

With the topknot adorned by the crown,
Praised by all the buddhas,
The jeweled diadem and
The silk-streamer empowerment I shall bestow.

oṃ vajra paṭṭa ka vajra a ralli ho

Saying this, one gives it.

Then one places the vajra in front. From its non-apprehension, from jaṃ it turns into a lotus, from which one generates Amitābha. One places the vajra that arises from his complete transformation at the disciple's heart and says this:

This is all the buddhas themselves,
Glorious Heruka, the king,
And the supreme empowerment of the ḍākinīs;
Today I confer it upon you.

oṃ śrī he ru ka a dhi pa ti stvaṃ a bhi ṣiñca tiṣṭha bī ra sa ma ya stvaṃ

The being without beginning or end,
Vajrasattva, great in joy,
Samantabhadra, the self of all,
The proud vajra, lord of lords.

Saying this, one gives it into the right hand. This is the vajra empowerment.

Then one places the bell in front. From its non-apprehension, the bell that has arisen from khaṃ, a sword and Amoghasiddhi is given into the left hand, and one says this:

This, all the yoginīs declare,
Follows the melody of wisdom;
You too must hold it always.

So the Victors have taught for supreme awakening.
Existence is pure in its essential nature;
By its essential nature it is made without entity.
The being pure by intrinsic nature
Will bring about sublime existence.

oṃ vajra stva tvaṃ sa ma ya a bhi ṣi ñcā mi

Saying this, one gives it into the left hand. This is the bell empowerment.

Having given the bell in this way, one imagines the disciple as endowed with the great seal (mahāmudrā), and then the empowerment name should be given with the mantra:

oṃ śrī he ru ka a dhi pa ti stvaṃ a bhi ṣi ñcā mi śrī he ru ka nā ma a bhi ṣe ka ta

Saying this, one confers the name empowerment, with a name that includes the word śrī and ends in Padma.

This is all the buddhas themselves,
Held in the hand of glorious Heruka.
You must always hold it,
The steadfast discipline of glorious Heruka.

Having the disciple take hold of the tip of the vajra, one recites this mantra:

oṃ sarva ta thā ga ta siddhi vajra sa ma ya tiṣṭha e ṣa tvaṃ dhā ra ya mi hūṃ ha ha ha ha ho

Saying this, one should confer, with the right hand, the empowerment of the vajra discipline.

One meditates on ā turning into a skull bowl, and on oṃ turning into a curved knife, and says this:

The khaṭvāṅga of glorious Heruka,
The ḍamaru drum of the yogin,
The vajra khaṭvāṅga together with the vajra,
The bell that rings out its tinkling sound,
O lord of yogins who wears the thread of Brahmā,
The curved knife and the skull cup:
Great hero, take them up!

With the curved knife and the skull cup one confers empowerment. To the disciple endowed with these one says: "Accomplish without hindrance pacifying, increasing, subjugating, the fierce rites, paralyzing, expelling, stupefying, killing and the rest, and all of these! Accomplish as you please all the accomplishments of the ḍākinīs, such as putting on the magic boots, bringing down rain, and seizing the sun and moon!" That is the giving of authorization.

The empowerments from the flower and the rest up to the empowerment of the curved knife and skull cup purify the body, and so they are called the body empowerment. If one asks with whom the result makes one of equal fortune: it makes one of equal fortune with a bodhisattva of the eighth ground.

Then, once the disciple has obtained the flower empowerment and the rest, the very place where the guru performs the conferral of the secret empowerment is made empty of people and secluded, and screened off with a curtain. A square maṇḍala is made and sprinkled with fragrances and nectar; on it loose flowers are scattered and various fine seats are spread. The disciple offers to the guru a wisdom consort endowed with the proper marks, and should make this supplication:

You are glorious Heruka;
Through the sugatas you bring bliss and the rest.
The perfectly pure, genuine, supreme aim
Of the great bodhisattvas,
Just as with that very nectar
The supreme empowerment was conferred,
So likewise, for me,
Please dispel the sufferings of saṃsāra.
Supreme stainless nectar of yoga,
Destroying the stain of the fault of blurred sight:
That unsurpassed awakening,
Please let me attain it today.

Saying this, one should make the supplication.

Then the guru generates the consort as Nairātmyā, sets the armor upon her, and also generates the three deities in the three places. He summons the wisdom being, causes it to enter, binds it, and pleases it, and dissolves it in; he adorns her head with Akṣobhya and says this. Blessing the secret space, he says:

oṃ padma su kha dhā ra ma hā rā ga su khaṃ da da ca tur ā na ndya bha ga bi śva hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ ka ryaṃ ku ru ṣva me oṃ vajra ma hā da śa ca tu ra ā nanda da ma ka kha ga mu khe ka rā śo nā tha hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ ka ryaṃ ku ru ṣva me

By saying this, one imagines that she is free of faults and completely pure.

Then one should enter into union. Remaining unmoving, light radiates from the hūṃ at the center of the emblem at the heart of one's own wisdom being and invites those who dwell in the ten directions; one performs their dissolving into the heart and the rest. When the blazing awakening mind has reached the neck of the bola, the male organ, one recites:

oṃ sarva ta thā ga tā nu rā ga ṇa vajra sva bhā va ātma ko'haṃ

and one takes pride in the thought, "I am of the nature of the vajra of passion." Then one presses the awakening mind at the neck of the bola with the thumb and ring finger, and should bring it to the disciple's mouth.

Then the master says, "Look at the u pa su mandra!" and says, "a ho su kha." The disciple says, "I am glorious Heruka of great bliss himself." This is said after it has been conferred and drunk. Because being touched by the glory of his vajra removes all the faults of speech and all conceptual thought, it is called the speech empowerment. Then, if one asks with whom the result makes one of equal fortune: one becomes of equal fortune with a bodhisattva of the tenth ground.

Since the disciple is of equal fortune with a bodhisattva of the tenth ground, a prophecy should be given to him. The guru puts on the Dharma robe, gathers the end of the robe into his left fist, and says this:

Thus I have fully taught:
Glorious Heruka, the Tathāgata,
In order to accomplish the supreme state,
Has drawn you out of the lower realms of existence.

śrī he ru ka na maḥ sarva ta thā ga ta hi siddha sa ma ya stvaṃ bhur bhu va svaḥ

So he says. When he abides in the mudrā of Amoghasiddhi, the Victors of the three times give the prophecy with one voice. This is the prophecy: "You will become lord of the three realms, you will become lord of the Victors, you will be victorious over the Māras of error, the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) and the rest, and you will enter the sublime city of nirvāṇa. Through this very

empowerment you will attain buddhahood, so do not give way to doubt, hesitation and the like!" Moreover, merely through being empowered by a holy guru, disciples will accomplish whatever they have in mind. That is the encouragement given to him.

Then one should begin the conferral of the wisdom and gnosis empowerment. This too has two parts: the wisdom empowerment and the wisdom-gnosis empowerment. For the wisdom empowerment, a young woman of the age given above is offered to the guru, and the maṇḍala, the sprinkling and the rest should be done as above. Then the guru blesses the consort as before, and the guru should instruct the consort and the disciple: "You must not abandon desire. The Sugatas of the three times too, by engaging in the play of the nonduality of method and wisdom, gave rise to great gnosis and became fully and perfectly awakened. You too must not abandon desire: engage in the play of nonduality! Gnosis will arise." Saying this, he instructs them.

The guru also says this:

Are you able, O vajra holder,
To eat and drink excrement and urine,
rakta, camphor and ma śa,
And are you able, with devotion, to serve women?
Will you kiss the bha ga without conceptualizing?
Speak out, O blissful vajra one!

Then the disciple and the consort together say these words of ability:

O goddess, why would I not be able?
I eat excrement, seed and the rest,
I hold the wisdom consort in true faith,
And I kiss the bha ga as well.

So they say. Then the consort is unclothed, bathed and anointed with fragrance, and a garland of flowers is tied on her head. Holding the two corners with her two hands, she opens it, and the consort says this:

Great marvel, this is my lotus,
Truly endowed with every bliss.
Always, in due order, enjoy it;
From it you will never be parted.
This dharmadhātu is utterly pure;
The realm of sentient beings is utterly freed.

This very Heruka, the king:
All natures abide in this.
At the wheel of the inner channels,
Entering the lotus, it is fully proclaimed.
Within the bha ga, like space,
The five elements are arrayed like ornaments.
Its center, with its anthers,
Is adorned with eight petals.
From its middle there comes forth
That very nectar in the form of śu kra.

bhañja mokṣa ho

So the consort says. Then the guru places the hand of the disciple and the hand of the consort one upon the other and says, "Since this consort generates your gnosis, keep company with her always, never parting." Just that is the wisdom empowerment.

Then the disciple and the consort both stay inside the curtain, and the disciple should receive the wisdom-gnosis empowerment. Then the disciple lies down with the consort, lying on the left side, and should speak words of love. He should make nail marks at the nine places. With the left hand placed beneath her left, he should do the rubbing with the elephant-trunk hand on what resembles a sparrow's head within the lotus, and the rest. Then he also plays again and again with the tongue, causing the lotus to open. Then he unites with the consort, and as he moves slowly, slowly, when the awakening mind reaches the neck of the bola, nonconceptual gnosis arises, and he meditates for as long as it remains.

Then, if he cannot hold it, he releases it into the kakkolar, the female organ, and since it is the very nature of Hevajra, he takes it up with the tongue. As the tantra says:

It should not be taken with the hand,
Nor with a mother-of-pearl shell,
Nor should it be placed in a conch;
The nectar should be taken with the tongue.

Therefore one should take it from the ka sko la with the tongue alone. Because one takes from the consort's kakkola the awakening mind that is of the nature of gnosis and consumes it, this is called the wisdom empowerment.

The four kinds of joy are these four: joy, true joy, natural joy, and the joy of cessation. Joy lasts from the first embrace until the awakening mind reaches the root of the bola. True joy is just when it has reached the middle. Natural joy is when it has reached the neck of the bola; that is the generation of nonconceptuality.

If one asks what they are needed for, the reply is: they are made to correspond to the nature of the four cakras. Someone objects: "Then how are they matched with the four cakras as four joys? There are only three, for the joy of cessation does not count." The reply: the joy of cessation does count. Why? Although there is no great joy in it, it counts as a momentary joy, so there is no contradiction. "Since the tantra also teaches the joys, matching them with the four cakras is not contradictory," and so forth: this is the conferral of the gnosis empowerment. Because it purifies all faults of mind, it is called the mind empowerment. If one asks with whom its result makes one of equal fortune: the yogin who has obtained such an empowerment becomes of equal fortune with the buddhas of the five families.

Then, at that time, the pledges should be properly assessed. Then a pacifying fire offering should be performed on the ground of the maṇḍala. This should be learned from other sources; it is not set out here.

Then the disciple says: "Gold and silver, precious jewels, coral, pearls, kā rā pa ṇa coins, elephants, buffaloes, carriages together with riches, and the finest gifts dear to my heart I offer to the guru, bowing at the guru's feet. From this moment on I am a servant at the guru's feet. Please accept my body as well." The master too, because he delights in having established his disciple in awakening, should speak, saying, "Great is your devotion, and great your wealth."

A disciple of great faith and devotion
Should first offer the fee;
A disciple without faith and devotion
Will not attain the accomplishments.

This is the procedure for offering the master's fee.

Then, with songs, dances and the like, and carrying many musical instruments, one should circumambulate the maṇḍala three times. One should prostrate. One should give torma to the guardians of the directions. One should recite words of aspiration. Then the materials, the colored powders and the rest,

should be gathered up at dawn the next morning. Once gathered, they are poured into a golden vase and should be cast into a great river. All the vases too are carried to the great river, and the vases are washed. As before, one turns the great feast gathering, the ga ṇa ca kra, and performs songs and dances. Then one mixes the five nectars, sandalwood, saffron and cow dung, smears the ground with them, and should make the colors and lines no longer visible.

The rite of the sequence of activities for the maṇḍala of the Blessed One Hevajra, composed in full and without error, is complete. Composed by the master Saroruhavajra; it is complete. Translated, edited and finalized by the Indian preceptor Gayādhara and the monk Shakya Yeshé.

Translator's Notes

• In "should perform the exhortation," the Tibetan reads □□□□□□□□□, whose first element is unclear here; it may stand for □□□□, "briefly," or refer to a set formula of exhortation. The phrase about the eastern elevation, literally "the four families and the five and so forth will be exhausted in realization," is rendered as full realization of these families.
• In the exhortation verses the epithet rendered "source of all" (kun 'byung) is not the second noble truth but a descriptive epithet of the deity. The lines on the dance moods are terse; "a fierce gaze like the full moon" renders a line whose exact sense is uncertain. "Tomorrow" reads nang par as nangs par.
• "Vairocana" renders snang mdzad, taken as a short form of the name used in the previous piece. The line rendered "the selfless bodhisattvas" (byang chub sems dpa' bdag med pa) might instead name the goddess Nairātmyā alongside the bodhisattvas. In the tooth-stick verses the sense of "not to be set down" (mi gdags) is uncertain. "Scented water" for washing renders dri chu, which in some tantric rites denotes urine; here the context of washing, sprinkling and drinking water suggests ordinary scented water.
• "Of clay" for the other vases reads khams as a slip for kham (clay), as in the preceding sentence. "Moon" and "sun" among the substances put into the vase are translated literally; they may be code names for substances such as camphor. The "actual lines" renders dus thig, whose exact technical sense is uncertain. The description of the circles, porticoes and wall sections in the drawing instructions is terse, and its exact geometry is uncertain, especially the sentence about the wheel of Dharma and the crossed vajra.
• The opening words of the empowerment section (here rendered "Here one proceeds to the conferral of empowerment") read 'di na mar, whose exact sense is unclear. "Caṇḍālī" here appears to denote the consort with whom the master practices; the alternative, practice through samādhi alone, is given when there is none. In the line on drawing with the little finger and thumb, the word sangs is taken loosely; the exact sense is uncertain.
• "Ornaments, the silk hangings and the rest" renders dar na pa ti, whose second part is unclear. In the disciple's supplication, "the source of qualities" (yon tan 'byung gnas) may be a personal name, Guṇākara, rather than an epithet; the line is ambiguous.
• The opening refers to the crown (diadem) of the preceding crown empowerment, which may be made of any of the listed materials. The phrase rendered "should all be done in the same way for all of them" reads □□□□□□□□□□□□□□, taken as □□□□□□□ "all alike". "Remaining

unmoving" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□; it could alternatively mean "assuming the form of Akṣobhya". □□□□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□□□□□□□□ "in the thought that I am", and □□□□□□□□□□□□□ as □□□□ "at the neck". □□□□ "opening" is taken as the disciple's mouth, since the next passage speaks of drinking.
• u pa su mandra is obscure; it is kept as written. In the guru's questions, rakta is blood and ma śa probably flesh, both coded names of the tantric substances; bha ga and kakkola denote the female organ, śu kra semen. The disciple's reply addresses "goddess" (□□□□□), though the parallel in the Hevajra Tantra addresses the Lord. The term rendered "the first embrace" (□□□□□□□□□□□□) is uncertain; it evidently names the opening stage of union. □□□□□□□□□□□□□, the fourth joy, is rendered "joy of cessation", since in this context □□□□ means the cessation of bliss rather than philosophical annihilationism.
• kā rā pa ṇa is the kārṣāpaṇa, an Indian coin.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.